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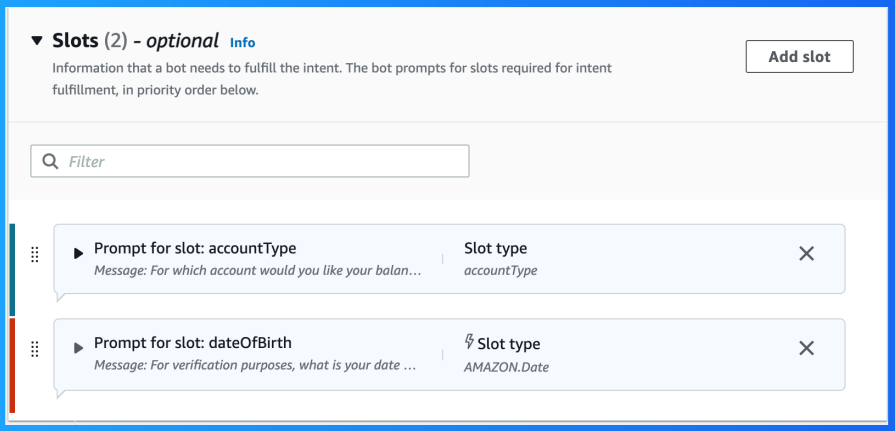
Build a Chatbot with Custom Slots

James Paonessa



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Introducing Today's Project!

Today we expanded on our BankerBot to add the ability to look for different types of accounts based on what we talked about with the chatbot.

What is Amazon Lex?

Amazon Lex is very useful chatbot system. It lets you create simple chatbots that can ends can interact with, similar to what you utilize with a bank or travel website.

One thing I didn't expect in this project was...

I did not expect how easy it would be for the chatbot to remmeber the authentication information presented and how it would carry it forward. I expected I would need to program that in vs it being an automated feature.

This project took me...

It took approximately 30 minutes to complete this project beyond the initial setup from previous projects.

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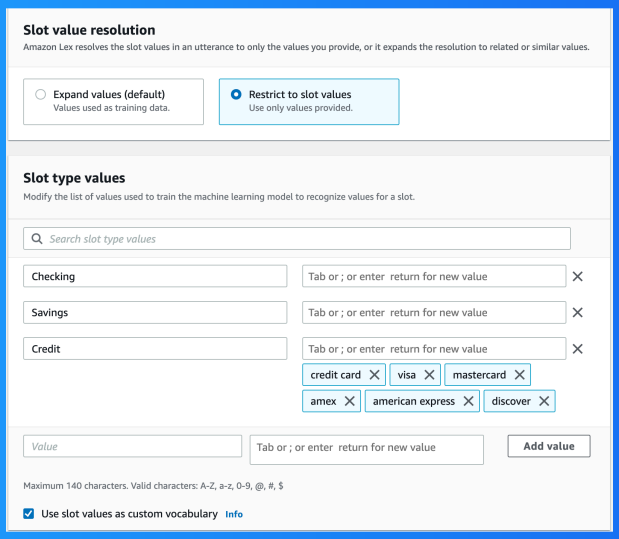
Slots

Slots are pieces of information the chatbot can use to complete the user's request.

By adding custom slots in utterances, my chatbot's users can pass along information from one part of the conversation to the next. For instance, the chatbot will now pass along the accountType through this utterance.

In this project, I created a custom slot type to determine the account type.



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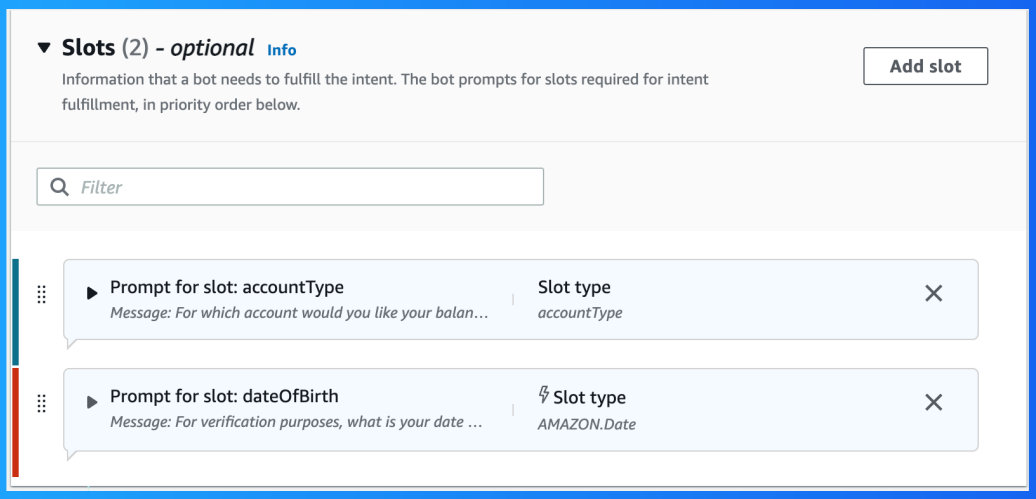
Connecting slots with intents

This slot type has restricted slot values, which means it will only utilize the values I have provided. This can be used to prevent the system from attempting to access types of accounts not offered.

I associated my custom slot with CheckBalance, which is the mechanism to begin the act of checking the balance of the specified account.



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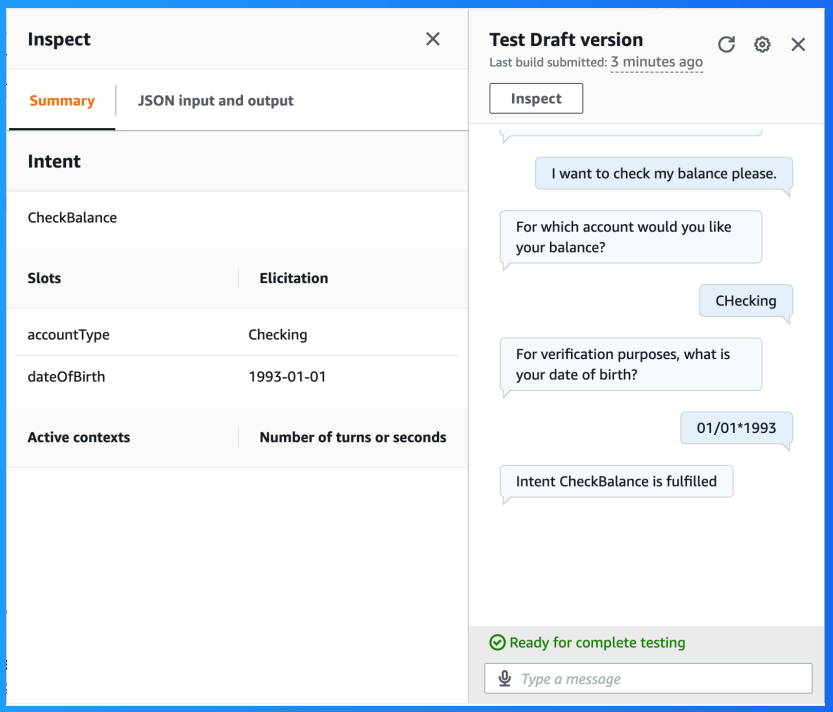
Slot values in utterances

I included slot values in some of the user inputs by including the text {accountType}. This allows the users input to direct what type of account to be looked for.